

THE EDIT ABROAD

Hawai'i

The Luxury Packing Guide

OAHU · MAUI · THE BIG ISLAND · KAUAI · MOLOKAI

WELCOME TO THE EDIT

Hawai‘i — Where the Pacific Meets the Sky

Hawaii is not one island — it is five distinct worlds, each with its own rhythm, landscape, and unspoken dress code. The sophistication of Honolulu's Kaimukī and Kakaako. The upcountry cool of Maui's Makawao. The raw volcanic wonder of the Big Island's Kona Coast. The jungle luxury of Kauai's Na Pali coast. And Molokai — still, sacred, and unhurried in a way the other islands have forgotten. Each island asks something slightly different of your wardrobe.

The local rule: aloha spirit is everything. Look effortless, respect the land, and never — ever — wear reef-unsafe sunscreen in the ocean.

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In Hawai‘i, the most beautiful thing you can wear is aloha. Dress accordingly.

”

YOUR DESTINATIONS

OAHU	MAUI	BIG ISLAND	KAUAI
O	M	BI	K

BEST TIME TO VISIT

Hawaii is beautiful year-round. Summer (June–September) is drier and warmer. Winter (November–March) brings bigger surf on north shores and occasional rain — but also fewer crowds.

JUNE–SEPT Dry, warm, ideal beaches	OCT–NOV Shoulder — best kept secret	DEC–MAR Whale season, big surf, cool
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Her Edit — Hawai'i Wardrobe

From Honolulu rooftops to Hāna highway lookouts

CLOTHING — WHAT TO PACK

DAYWEAR

Quality one-piece swimsuit × 2
Bikini sets (mix-and-match) × 2
Linen or cotton sundress × 3
High-waist shorts × 2
Flowy wide-leg linen pants × 1

EVENING & LAYERS

Breezy linen or cotton blouse × 2
Aloha/resort print dress × 1
Light knit for upcountry/AC × 1
Rashguard (surf or snorkel) × 1
Slip dress for Honolulu evenings × 1

SHOES

Reef sandal or Birkenstock — the true Hawaii local shoe for everything off-beach
Quality flip flop (Locals brand or Olukai) — beach and casual errands only
White leather sneaker — Kakaako art walks, Kaimukī restaurants, airport days
Strappy flat sandal — Honolulu dinner, Wailea resort evenings, Lānai day trips

ACCESSORIES

HEADWEAR & JEWELLERY

Wide-brim hat (UV50+ — UV index here is extreme)
Waterproof or resin jewellery only
Sarong (beach, coverup, blanket, temple)

BAGS & EYEWEAR

Waterproof dry bag (essential for beaches and Na Pali boats)
Quality polarised sunglasses (wraparound for water)
Small crossbody for town days

HER HAWAII STYLE PRINCIPLE

The palette: ocean teal, volcanic black, hibiscus red, sand, and every shade of green.
Local aesthetic: quality basics, natural fabrics, one beautiful print. Avoid resort-logo everything.
Upcountry Maui and Waimea (Big Island) get genuinely cool — always pack one layer.
Respect: cover up at heiau (sacred sites) and always ask before entering fishponds or taro fields.

OUTFIT INSPIRATION

BEACH DAY



Bikini, rashguard,
reef sandal, wide hat

TOWN & LUNCH



Linen sundress,
leather sandal, crossbody

HONOLULU EVE



Silk slip dress,
strappy flat, simple gold

His Edit — Hawai'i Wardrobe

Island life, done with intention

CLOTHING — WHAT TO PACK

TOPS & TROUSERS

Quality board shorts × 2
Swim trunks (non-logo) × 1
Aloha shirt (quality, tonal) × 2
Linen shirt (open, breezy) × 2
Quality cotton or linen tee × 3

LAYERS & EVENING

Linen or chino shorts × 2
Light linen trousers (evenings) × 1
Rashguard (surf/snorkel) × 1
Smart casual shirt (Honolulu) × 1
Light layer (upcountry/AC) × 1

SHOES

Olukai or quality leather sandal — the local standard for daily island life
Reef sandal (Teva or Chaco) — beach hikes, tidal pools, and Napali boat landings
White leather sneaker — Honolulu, Pāia, Kapaa town errands
Simple flip flop (Locals brand) — beach only, never town or restaurants

ACCESSORIES

WARDROBE DETAILS

Quality polarised sunglasses (UV400)
Waterproof watch (essential on islands)
Waterproof dry bag

BAGS & EYEWEAR

Canvas or woven day pack
Wide-brim or surf cap (UV50+)
Minimal leather belt

DRESS CODE — BY OCCASION

Beach & ocean:

Town & café:

Honolulu dinner:

Upcountry / hike:

Board shorts or swim trunks, rashguard, reef sandal — ocean-ready
Linen shorts, quality tee or aloha shirt, sandal — neat island casual
Linen trousers, aloha or smart shirt, leather sandal — Honolulu has standards
Long pants, moisture-wicking layer, trail shoe — it gets cool and steep

OUTFIT INSPIRATION

OCEAN READY



Board shorts,
rashguard, reef sandal

ISLAND TOWN



Linen shorts, aloha
shirt, leather sandal

HONOLULU EVE



Linen trousers, smart
shirt, leather shoe

BEAUTY & TOILETRIES

What to Bring

The UV index in Hawaii reaches 11+ in summer — the highest classification possible. Reef-safe sunscreen is not optional — it is the law in Hawaii. Oxybenzone and octinoxate are banned. Bring mineral SPF only, or buy at any Long's Drugs or Whole Foods on arrival.

HER BEAUTY BAG

Mineral SPF 50+ face (reef-safe only)
 Tinted mineral SPF or bronzing drops
 Waterproof mascara (one coat only)
 Tinted lip balm SPF 30+
 Salt spray for effortless beach waves
 Coconut or monoi hair oil
 After-sun aloe gel (buy local)
 Light, fresh perfume (floral or ocean)

HIS GROOMING KIT

Mineral SPF 50+ face (reef-safe only)
 Light cologne (nothing heavy in heat)
 Beard oil or balm
 Lip balm SPF 30+ (reef-safe)
 Deodorant (natural if possible)
 Hair paste (surf-compatible formula)
 After-sun aloe gel
 Face wipes for humid days

ESSENTIALS & SMART TRAVEL

TECH & PRACTICALITIES

US Type A/B plugs (no adapter needed)
 Waterproof phone case (mandatory near water)
 Reusable insulated water bottle (UV dehydrates fast)
 Reef-safe sunscreen (bring or buy immediately)

THE EXTRAS THAT MATTER

Snorkel mask (own > rental for hygiene)
 National Parks pass (Big Island volcanoes)
 Offline maps — Na Pali and Hāna have no signal
 Cash USD — farmers markets and food trucks are cash-only

WHAT NOT TO PACK — EVER

Non-reef-safe sunscreen — it is illegal in state waters and harmful to the reef you came to see
 Flip flops for hiking — Hawaii trails are serious terrain and people get hurt underestimating them
 Loud resort logo clothing — locals notice and it signals you as a tourist, not a traveler
 Anything white near red Kauai dirt roads — the laterite soil stains permanently and magnificently
 Heels of any kind — the islands are sand, lava rock, and wooden lanai floors
 Clothes that need dry-cleaning — salt, sun, and humidity will test every fabric you own

PACKING STRATEGY & CHECKLIST

Island by Island — The Insider Approach

OAHU: Stay in Kaimukī or Kakaako, not Waikīkī — eat at Mud Hen Water, swim at Laniakea.

MAUI: Base in Pāia for the north shore or Wailea for luxury — do the Road to Hāna slowly.

BIG ISLAND: Stay in Waimea or Kona — Kona Coast snorkeling is world-class, and Volcano National Park is a worthy drive.

KAUAI: North Shore for beauty (Haena, Hanalei) — Na Pali by boat is non-negotiable.

MOLOKAI: Go if you want the real Hawaii — no resorts, no tours, just land and community.

“

Mahalo. The ocean is sacred here. Dress like you know it.

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MASTER PACKING CHECKLIST

Print this page and tick each item as you pack.

HER CLOTHING	HIS CLOTHING	BEAUTY & GROOMING	EXTRAS & DOCS
☐ One-piece swimsuit × 2 ☐ Bikini sets × 2 ☐ Linen sundress × 3 ☐ High-waist shorts × 2 ☐ Wide-leg pants × 1 ☐ Linen blouse × 2 ☐ Aloha/print dress × 1 ☐ Light knit × 1 ☐ Rashguard × 1 ☐ Slip dress × 1 ☐ Reef sandal/Birkenstock ☐ Quality flip flop ☐ White sneaker ☐ Strappy flat sandal ☐ Wide-brim UV hat ☐ Dry bag	☐ Board shorts × 2 ☐ Swim trunks × 1 ☐ Aloha shirt × 2 ☐ Linen shirt × 2 ☐ Quality tee × 3 ☐ Linen/chino shorts × 2 ☐ Linen trousers × 1 ☐ Rashguard × 1 ☐ Smart casual shirt × 1 ☐ Light layer × 1 ☐ Olukai/leather sandal ☐ Reef sandal ☐ White sneaker ☐ Flip flop (beach only) ☐ Polarised sunglasses ☐ Day pack	☐ Reef-safe SPF 50+ ☐ Tinted mineral SPF ☐ Waterproof mascara ☐ Tinted lip balm SPF ☐ Salt spray ☐ Coconut/monoi oil ☐ After-sun aloe ☐ Light perfume/cologne ☐ Natural deodorant ☐ Beard oil/balm ☐ Lip balm SPF ☐ Hair paste ☐ Face wipes ☐ Dry shampoo ☐ Waterproof phone case ☐ Power bank	☐ Cash USD ☐ Snorkel mask ☐ National Parks pass ☐ Offline maps ☐ Reusable bottle ☐ Reef-safe SPF (extra) ☐ Dry bag ☐ Travel insurance ☐ Passport (if inter-island) ☐ Hotel confirmations ☐ Pain reliever ☐ Motion sickness tabs ☐ Plasters ☐ Insect repellent ☐ Earplugs ☐ Eye mask